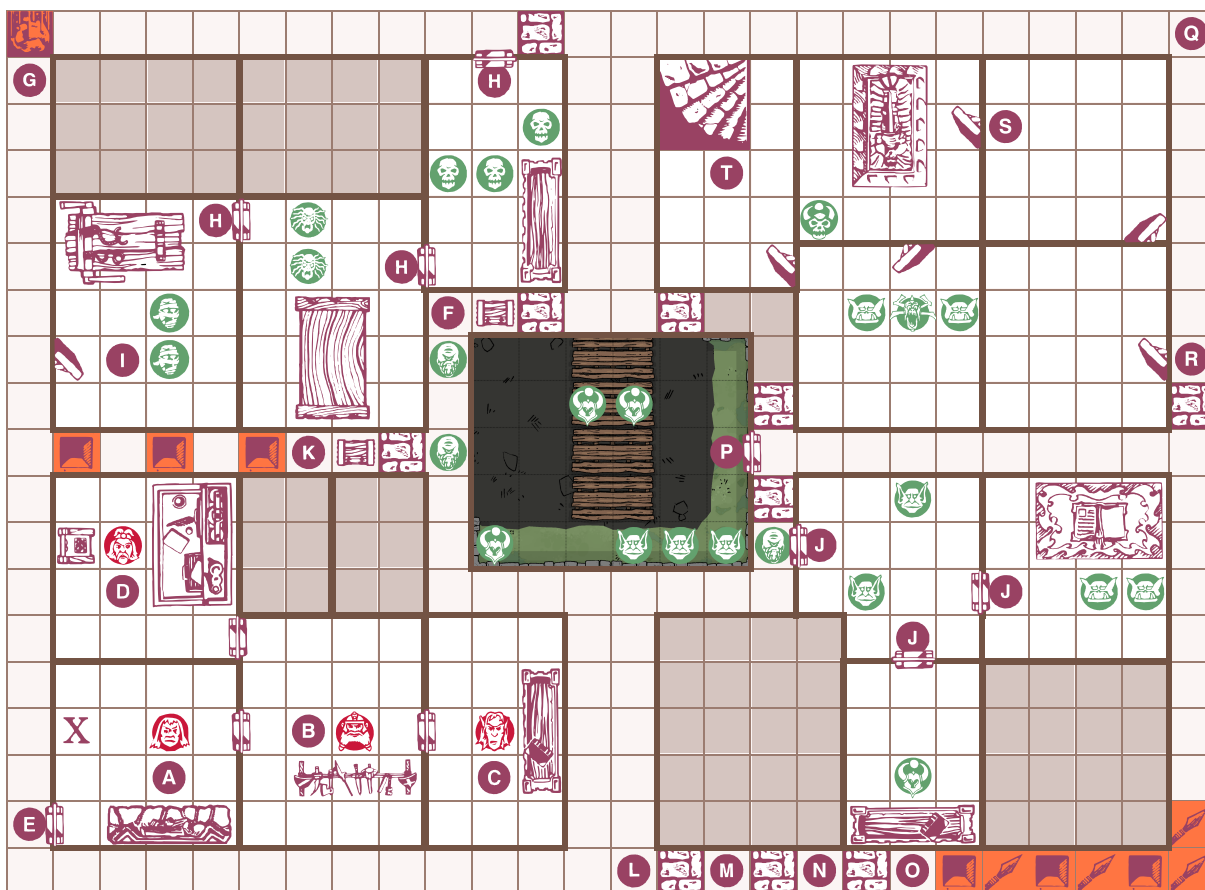




5. The Secrets of Seoraksan

Last time, on Huntr/X Quest:

The girls entered the Library of Jang, which was overrun with demons, but managed to escape with the Chronicles of Mudang.

After pouring over its pages, they learned a great deal.

The archdemon Agwi Hwasin has existed since time immemorial, spawned from the first act of pure malice committed by a human. He is as cunning as he is powerful, fueled by the hatred and contempt expressed by mankind towards each other. The last time he came to the surface hundreds of years ago, he attempted to conduct a ritual that would turn all of the humans in the world into soulless demons under his command. He was contained and pushed back to the underworld, but not truly defeated. It sounds like he must be back to finish the job he started long ago.

It also revealed that here, on Jeju Island, there exists a still active entrance to the underworld. It is said that an early group of hunters used this portal to try and attack Gwi-

Ma directly, but when they never returned it was sealed and in time nearly forgotten. The monks who live at the temple built around it are some of the few people who remain that know it exists.

Finally, you have found a way to save Celine. You resolve to head to Seoraksan and make your way up the mountain to reach this cavern temple, and from there into the underworld itself.

Now heroes, prepare yourselves for Chapter 5: The Secrets of Seoraksan.

You have journeyed far up the mountain, and have come to a cliffside temple. Further up one of these foreboding paths is the way to the cave where the passage is sealed, but you neither know which path to traverse nor how to unseal the passage when you get there. You decide to speak to the locals (speaking to NPCs uses your Action for the turn).

X - The girls start here.

A - *You greet the monk, and ask if he knows anything about the entrance

to the underworld. His eyes narrow, and he leans in to whisper to you. "You seek passage into the underworld? I would not do that if I were you. It is dangerous, and if left unsealed the passage could unleash all manner of foul creatures. We have sealed the way for the protection of humanity. Please reconsider whatever it is that you are planning."

Make an assisted Contested Mind Check vs. 3 dice.

If you win:

You manage to convince the monk of the importance of your mission. "Very well. I will remove the traps I set on the passage. The path lies directly to the East as you exit the temple, but will not be accessible until you convince the other monks to clear the obstacles they have put in the way." (The traps at O are now disabled)

If you lose:

The monk hears your plea, but shakes his head. "I am sorry, it is too dangerous. If you really want to do this, speak with the other monks. But you will get no help from me in this foolish endeavor."

B - *You greet this stout monk as he's in the midst of forging a new weapon. A fine rack of armaments stands nearby, and the walls are covered in the tools of his craft. "Aye lad, yer seeking entrance to the underworld eh? Well I need something from ye first. The path to the north leads to my old cavern workshop, but the ceiling was crumbling and we had to abandon it. But I left my best hammer in there. If you bring it back, I can help you."

If you bring back his hammer:

"Yes, this is the one! It's a fine hammer. Thank you. I'll make sure I open the stone blockage I put up. You'll need to talk with my fellow monks if you want the path to be completely opened, however." (The stone at L is now removed)

C - *This monk appears to be busy searching through books. He takes one off the nearby bookshelf, flips through frantically, and then puts it back to grab another. Finally he looks away from a book long enough to greet you, turning his head just barely in your direction. "Ah, how long have you been standing here? Well no matter, no matter. I can't find my recipe book, and the monks are demanding my special stew! What did you say? You want passage to the underworld? I can remove my blockade along the path if you can retrieve my recipe book. Before I became a monk, I had a small cottage down the eastern path, and then turning to the north and east. I bet I left it there."*

If you bring back the recipe book:

"Yes, yes this is it! Oh thank you! I will ensure that my obstacle is removed in time for your journey." (The stone at M is now removed)

D - *This monk is flipping through a large stack of papers on his desk. He looks up to greet you. "Oh, good day to you. I heard that you are seeking passage to the underworld. It's a dangerous thing you're attempting, but I know that you hunters are capable of defending yourselves. There is something that I need from you, however, before you go. I am busy copying these documents, but I've run out of calligraphy ink. I left some in my storage locker, to the west and then north of here. I put it there to safeguard my valuables, but the place has been overrun by foul creatures. Could you dispatch them and return my calligraphy ink?"*

If you bring back the ink:

"Thank you, brave heroes! I will ensure that, for my part, your path will be clear. Make sure to talk to the others ere you depart. And good luck. The last hunters that passed through never returned." (The stone at N is now removed)

E - When the first hero exits the temple, say:

You exit the temple to find yourself on a perilously narrow trail dropping off to the side of the mountain. The trail splits here, both north and to the east, and both paths appear to be carved into the cliffside. This is a dangerous road, tread carefully.

F - Once the monsters in this corridor are defeated, a hero who searches will find calligraphy ink instead of pulling a treasure card.

G - Once all four heroes pass by this falling stone trap, say:

It's a cave in! The path behind you is blocked. You'll need to find another way back.

H - *You come to a small wooden door mounted crudely over the entrance of a cave, its wood rotten and its hinges rusting. Pushing it open, you see the rusted evidence of an old smithery, and several demons milling about who turn towards you as the light from the newly opened door brightens the space for the first time in years. (All other H doors open when the first one does).*

I - When the enemies are defeated and a search is performed:

You sift through the cobwebs and debris, until at last you find a smithing hammer among the detritus. What's more, you find a secret passage leading back out of the cavern. (reveal the secret passage)

J - *Here on the mountainside, you find a cozy but abandoned cottage. The light blue paint is peeling from the outer walls, and the door is suspiciously ajar. Pushing it open, you find demons rummaging through what remains! (All other J doors open when the first one does)*

When they defeat the monsters here and search, they find a Recipe Book and a Potion of Concentrated Honmoon on the altar.

K - A hero who reaches this chest can open it. Inside is 200gp per hero, stashed away by a monk for a rainy day.

L - When the first hero approaches it: *This stone seems strangely out of place. But you cannot seem to move it even though you push with all your might.* Removed with (B).

M - Removed with (C).

N - Removed with (D).

O - If you convinced (A) to help you, remove all of these traps.

P - *You come to a deep crevice in the mountain, with a rickety wooden bridge traversing it. But you are not alone: these demons appear to have been waiting for you!*

Q - When the first hero reaches this tile: *Climbing up the steepest cliffside passage, you can at last see the entrance to a cave in the distance. Surely this must be where the passage to the underworld was sealed.* (Place the secret passage markers in each of the following rooms as soon as the heroes are able to see them, but do not reveal the contents of the next room until directed)

R - As you reach this tile: *You have made it to the entrance of a small and very dark cave. Your torch can barely penetrate the darkness. The air is foul, as if sulfur is billowing out from some passage deeper within. Proceed carefully. (When a hero enters a room, reveal the passage to the next room and any contents of the current room, but no further)

S - As a hero reaches this tile: *Pushing through this passage, previously unseen candles along the walls light up, revealing a stone tomb - and horrifying demons! The nearest demon reaches towards you with a flame-enwrapped hand as it scowls menacingly. Defend yourselves!*

All of the secret passages immediately open. Reveal all of the contents of each room.

The Chaos Sorcerer has the following stats: Attack: 2 Defense: 3 Body Points: 7 Mind Points: 8 Type: Tactical Maneuver: Recharge Spells: Ball of Flame, Firestorm, Summon Undead.

Upon searching, the heroes will find 300gp in the old tomb instead of drawing a treasure card.

T = When the heroes make it onto this tile, say:

The dimly lit passage descends into what looks like total darkness. This must be what you were looking for. The overpowering scent of sulfur emanating

from the passage fills your nostrils. With Celine in your thoughts, you bravely 500gp worth of experience and wisdom. begin the long descent into the underworld. Your bravery gains each of you

Wandering Monster in this Quest is: **Orc**

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